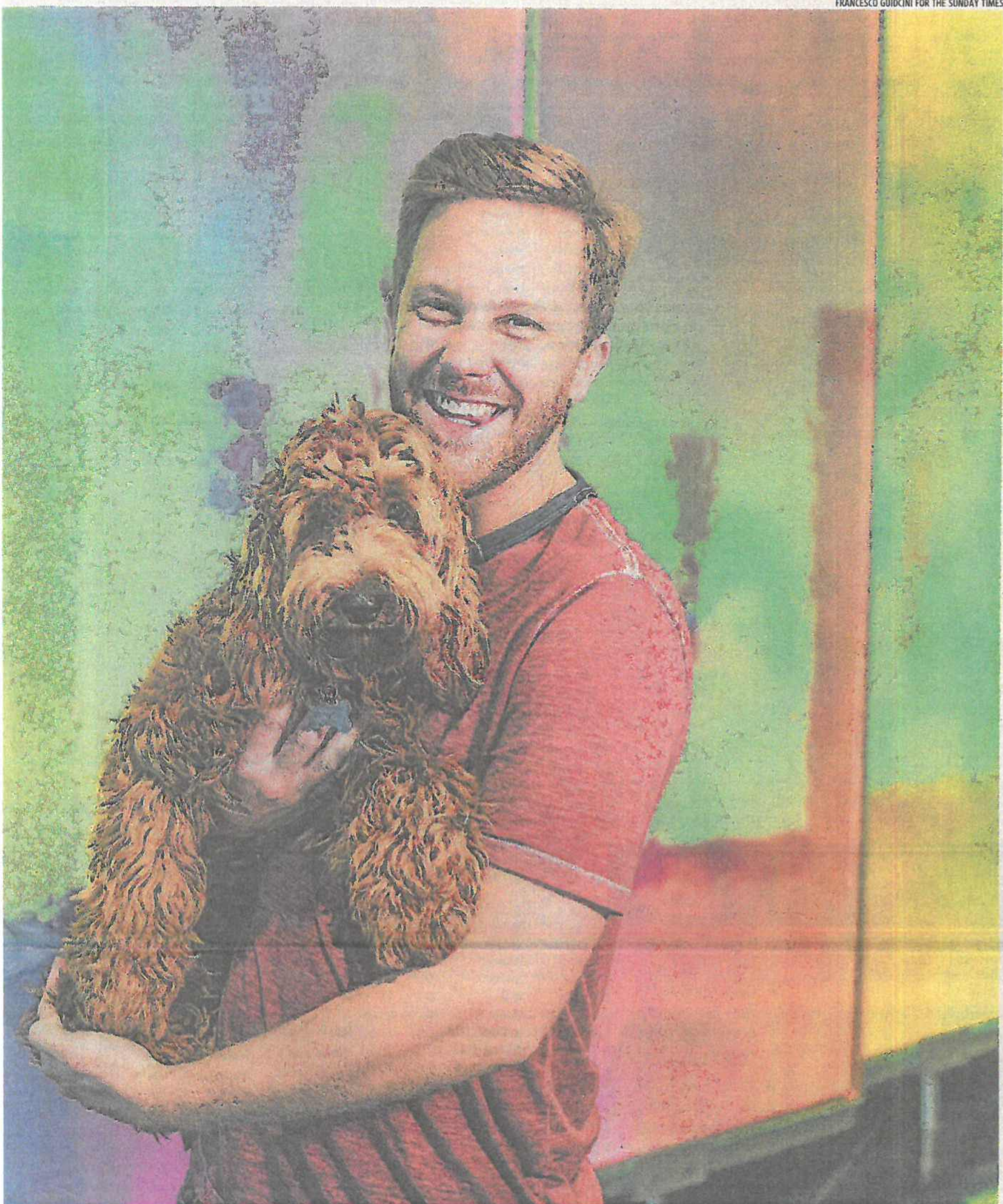


Exhibit 10

Founders of the Future startup competition "The F Factor" in The Times

FRANCESCO GUIDICINI FOR THE SUNDAY TIMES



Monzo start-up grow into one of the biggest of Britain's challenger banks, but David Brear, left, fears that many are set to fail

that little of substance has been achieved," McKinsey said in research published in January. "The bottom line is that despite billions of dollars of investment and nearly as many headlines, evidence for a practical, scalable use for blockchain [in

financial services] is thin on the ground." "Billions" is a word that crops up often in the financial technology sector. Companies with billion-dollar valuations are the so-called unicorns that politicians and

entrepreneurs dream of, but those values are not locked in stone. Indeed, the private market valuations being ascribed to some of Britain's fintech unicorns seem to some to be heroically optimistic. So will investors head for the exit?

Carney looks to technology to ease the path to finance

Last week's Mansion House dinner was overshadowed by climate change protesters and the rough treatment of one of their number by Mark Field MP, but financial technology companies had something positive to remember about the event (James Hurley writes). Mark Carney said that the Bank of England would open up its balance sheet to a new generation of payment providers, giving a big boost to fintech start-ups.

Historically, only commercial banks have been able to hold funds overnight in interest-bearing accounts at the central bank. Now that ability will be opened to all payment providers willing to meet the bank's regulatory standards. The move would increase competition and would reduce the reliance on

the big banks, the governor said.

The move will be perceived as a threat to incumbent banks that have been able to profit from acting as intermediaries to other payments companies.

Mr Carney, 54, also made supportive noises about the potential for fintech to improve the ability of small businesses to access finance. He noted that small companies faced a £22 billion funding gap, that half did not plan to use external finance and that there was a mismatch between how traditional lenders write loans and the needs of modern entrepreneurs.

"Part of the problem is that the assets that [small businesses] are seeking to borrow against are increasingly intangible — the value of a brand or user base — rather than physical assets, like building or

machinery," he said. Small companies that have not borrowed previously, meanwhile, lack the historic data that lenders require for credit scoring, he said, while "legal requirements to prevent money laundering and 'know your customer' make the process especially burdensome for a small business with limited resources".

He said that technology promised a future in which lenders and borrowers could rely on a broader set of information, thanks to data generated by online activity. Mr Carney cited the example of Iwoca, a lending start-up, that has made more than £900 million of loans to 25,000 small businesses, with factors such as online sales and customer reviews used to determine whether a borrower is creditworthy.

Maybe not, if only because one of their favoured "exit" routes may be closed, or at least less enticing. When Funding Circle, the loss-making peer-to-peer lender, listed its shares on the stock market last October, they opened at 440p. They plunged by 24 per cent on the day of the IPO and are now trading at around 240p. Cashing out now would be costly.

Nor do the risks end there. Peer-to-peer lending, comprising the online lending brokers that make up one of the more mature areas of the fintech industry, has been subject to concerns that some platforms may have been lending irresponsibly. When Lendy, a peer-to-peer player that had £160 million in outstanding loans, of which £90 million was in default, went bust on May 24, worries about the wider sector were amplified.

Ian Rand, Barclays' business banking chief, recently warned of a bubble in the UK's peer-to-peer market, saying that too much of the sector had been picking up high-risk credit that had been turned down by banks — the inference being that bubbles burst. Should it happen in Britain, it is unlikely to be on the scale

of the one that exploded in China, where hundreds of lending platforms have collapsed in recent years. Nor is it likely to be across the board. Mr Brear insists that at least three of the present digital banks will survive in the long term, noting that it took First Direct, launched by Midland Bank way back in 1989, three decades to gain its 1.45 million customers.

"The SME space, with all the RBS money sloshing around — [the state-rescued lender was forced to set up a £775 million alternative remedies package to provide to rivals after its failure to spin off Williams & Glyn as a standalone bank] — is going to kick in now, with some very different opportunities," he said. "And wealth management is also going to really kick in, with people like Freetrade [a stock investing app], flying that flag."

In short, Mr Brear's "reckoning" is not going to be the end of the story. Once the hype has died down and financial technology players have become less dependent on generous infusions of venture capital cash and more focused on sustainable growth, then they will start to disrupt the existing players out of existence — rather than merely talking about it.

Young entrepreneurs must flex their muscles to get ahead

Benedict George

Inspiration struck Harvinder Power when he arrived home from university one day to find his dad playing *Wii Sports*, the Nintendo video game.

A page of exercise instructions that his father had been given by a physiotherapist was still stuck to the fridge door, largely ignored since it had been received. Now that exercise was fun, however, he was making enthusiastic lunges not so different from the ones detailed by the physio.

Mr Power, from South Kensington, started a venture based on that incident that has seen him win the 19 to 25-year-old category in F Factor, a nationwide competition for young entrepreneurs.

His business, Motics, uses wearable technology to improve outcomes for physiotherapy patients. Users wear sensors that can detect muscle function, while electrical signals stimulate muscles. Games can make sessions

competitive, while recovery is tracked to allow people to see their progress. Appointments can be done over video call.

Mr Power, 23, a fifth-year medical student at Imperial College London, used work placements during his degree to confirm with physiotherapists that his father's case was not unusual. "Typically it's about a one, two-month waiting list just to see a physiotherapist," he said. "Then you don't really know what to do. You might have a couple of exercises, but you're not really sure if you're doing them right."

The Motics platform promises to reduce waiting times for physio appointments, as each patient will take up less staff time. That pitch has brought 15 clinics on board across London and Dublin. The company is looking to raise funding.

F Factor aims to give young people experience of starting a business, as



Rose Dyson, 19, founded her Yorkshire-based Pura Cosmetics when she was 16

well as introductions to advisers and investors. Winners in two age groups receive a £10,000 grant.

Rose Dyson, 19, founder and chief executive of the South Yorkshire-based

Pura Cosmetics, secured the award in the 14 to 18-year-old category. She was 16 when she founded the company. Ms Dyson wanted skincare products that were not tested on animals and would

suit sensitive skin, but could not afford to buy such products because of their "extortionate" mark-ups.

She entered an inter-school business competition in 2014 with homemade lip balms and lip scrubs. Until she moved recently to a small unit in Barnsley, all her manufacturing took place in her mother's kitchen.

"I was just a kid at school who got involved with everything. It was seen as geeky, but I'm glad I did it now," she said. She turned over nearly £50,000 last year, despite running the operation almost single-handedly.

Other than competition winnings, the only funding she has put into the business was the £25 she started with. Being scouted for the BBC show *Dragons' Den* two years ago could have brought her a lot more investment, but at a possible sacrifice of equity. Competition winnings have let her keep control for now. Besides, *Dragons' Den* wouldn't let her on. She was too young.